

# Cost-Benefit Analysis (CBA) Checklist

## 1. Define the Decision Context

- What is the problem or opportunity?
- Who are the key stakeholders?
- What decision needs to be made?
- What are the alternatives being considered?

## 2. Identify Costs and Benefits

- Labor (time, skills needed)
- Tools/subscriptions/licenses
- Opportunity cost (what you're not doing)
- Implementation/maintenance overhead
- Revenue growth or savings
- Time saved or efficiency gained
- Improved customer experience
- Reduced risk or technical debt

## 3. Forecast Outcomes

- Gather historical or benchmark data
- Build models or use estimation frameworks
- Account for uncertainty (e.g., best/worst/base case)
- Document all assumptions clearly

## 4. Compare Scenarios

- Define at least 23 options (status quo + alternatives)
- Outline costs/benefits for each
- Rank options by ROI, feasibility, and strategic alignment
- Consider qualitative trade-offs (e.g., brand, team effort)

## 5. Communicate the Recommendation

- Summarize assumptions in plain language
- Visualize key metrics (tables, bar charts, diagrams)

- Highlight trade-offs and risks
- Keep it brief decision-makers love clarity

## **Final Tips**

- Check for bias are assumptions overly optimistic?
- Make it reproducible others should be able to rerun the logic
- Save your work for audit/reuse later